Emirates — Unusual Baggage and Special Allowances

Document Type: Baggage Policy
Source: User-provided Emirates webpage content
Purpose: Structured document for an Emirates RAG chatbot dataset

1. Overview

Emirates provides special baggage allowances and handling rules for certain passengers and items.

The policy covers:

- Passengers with disabilities
- Passengers travelling with infants
- Sports equipment
- Pets
- Musical instruments
- Ship models
- Items containing explosives
- Personal motorised vehicles

Items containing explosives and personal motorised vehicles are prohibited on Emirates flights.

2. Passengers with Disabilities

Passengers with disabilities are entitled to additional baggage allowances free of charge, subject to the following conditions:

- Wheelchairs: Passengers travelling with their own wheelchair may check a fully collapsible wheelchair.
- Braces and crutches: Passengers who require braces or crutches may check these items.
- Portable dialysis machines: Passengers dependent on a portable dialysis machine may check one machine and all associated equipment.
- Assistance dogs: Vision- and hearing-impaired passengers who rely on assistance dogs may bring them. The dogs must be transported in kennels in the aircraft's hold and are not permitted in the cabin.

- Sleep apnea devices: Passengers with sleep disorders may carry one CPAP (Continuous Positive Airway Pressure) or PAP (Positive Airway Pressure) device as checked baggage, subject to IATA Dangerous Goods Regulations.

For information about using these devices in flight, see Health and Accessible Travel.

2.1 Portable Dialysis Machines

A portable dialysis machine may be carried as cabin baggage if:

- It fits within the size and weight limits of the passenger's travel class.
- It can be safely stowed in the cabin.
- It complies with Emirates' safety and dangerous goods rules.

The machine cannot be used during the flight.

If it cannot be carried in the cabin, one machine and all its associated equipment may be checked in free of charge.

Refer to Cabin Baggage Rules for applicable size and weight limits.

3. Passengers Travelling with Infants

Passengers travelling with infants under two years of age have different baggage allowances depending on their itinerary.

3.1 Routes Excluding the Americas and Africa

- Cabin baggage: One bag with maximum dimensions of 22 × 15 × 8 inches (55 × 38 × 22 cm) and a maximum weight of 5 kg (11 lb).
- Checked baggage: Up to 10 kg (22 lb).

3.2 Routes To and From the Americas and Africa

- Cabin baggage: One bag with maximum dimensions of 22 × 15 × 8 inches (55 × 38 × 22 cm) and a maximum weight of 5 kg (11 lb).
- Checked baggage: Up to 23 kg (50 lb).

The applicable baggage allowance will be shown on the infant's ticket.

3.3 Additional Infant Items

Passengers may ask check-in staff whether space is available to carry any one of the following items on board free of charge:

- Fully collapsible stroller or pushchair
- Infant's carrycot
- Infant's car seat

To carry an approved car seat, passengers should contact Emirates to purchase an additional aircraft seat at the appropriate child fare.

For further information, see Travelling with Infants.

4. Sports Equipment

Emirates accepts sporting equipment, including golf equipment, bicycles and ski equipment, as checked baggage within the standard baggage allowance.

Passengers intending to check a bicycle should contact Emirates at least 24 hours before departure. Special packaging rules may apply.

4.1 Weight Concept

Individual items with total dimensions exceeding 300 cm (118 inches) cannot be transported as checked baggage. They must be sent as cargo or freight. No exceptions apply.

4.2 Piece Concept

The total dimensions (length + width + height) of the entire piece of sporting equipment must not exceed 300 cm (118 inches).

Sporting equipment exceeding this limit cannot be transported as checked baggage and must be sent as cargo or freight.

If the total baggage weight or number of bags, including sports equipment, exceeds the complimentary baggage allowance, excess baggage charges will apply.

See Purchase Additional Baggage Allowance.

4.3 Self-Contained Underwater Breathing Apparatus (SCUBA)

SCUBA equipment normally includes:

- Diving suits
- Flippers
- Masks
- Snorkels
- Buoyancy control devices

If air bottles are carried, they must be emptied.

4.4 Sporting Weapons and Ammunition

Firearms designed for sporting purposes, such as target pistols, rifles, air guns, safari rifles and hunting rifles, may be carried as checked baggage under specific conditions.

The following rules apply:

1. The firearm must be completely unloaded and, if possible, dismantled and packed inside a suitcase or standard gun case.
2. Emirates must approve the carriage of firearms, ammunition and explosives at least three days before the flight.
3. Passengers must complete the Firearms Form through the Emirates Help Centre.
4. Passengers should allow additional time for public holidays and weekends in their country of residence and the UAE.
5. Ammunition must be securely stored in a strong, sealed box packed inside a suitcase and surrounded by other contents.
6. The suitcase must not bear an “Explosive” label.
7. The maximum gross weight of ammunition carried by one customer is 5 kg (11 lb).

Customers travelling in groups must carry ammunition in separate bags, with no individual bag exceeding the 5 kg (11 lb) limit.

4.4.1 Additional Conditions for Flights Into or Through Dubai

- Customers bringing firearms and ammunition into the UAE must obtain prior clearance from UAE Customs and the UAE Ministry of Defence. They must contact these government departments directly.
- Transfer and transit customers connecting to onward flights must obtain prior clearance from the Dubai Airport Police Department and the Department of Civil Aviation.

4.5 Ski Equipment

Ski equipment may be carried as part of the normal baggage allowance. Additional charges may apply in some situations.

Passengers should contact their local Emirates office for further information.

A set of snow ski equipment may consist of:

- One pair of skis, one pair of ski poles and one pair of ski boots; or
- One snowboard and one pair of boots.

A set of water ski equipment may consist of:

- One pair of standard water skis; or
- One slalom water ski.

For itineraries involving North, Central or South America, see the ski equipment baggage FAQ.

4.6 Other Sports Equipment

Emirates accepts windsurf boards, kite-surfing equipment, kayaks, bodyboards, pole vault equipment and other sporting equipment as checked baggage within the standard baggage allowance, provided that:

- Any sails are detachable and collapsible.
- The equipment is appropriately packed in a hard-shell case. Otherwise, a Limited Release will be required.
- The total dimensions do not exceed 300 cm (118 inches).

4.6.1 Surfboard Packing Precautions

Passengers must take the following precautions when packing surfboards:

- Remove the fins. If they cannot be removed, pack them firmly with polystyrene foam.
- Attach bubble wrap or neoprene foam to both the nose and tail.
- Place cardboard along the rails (sides of the board) to absorb shock.
- Pack the board in a properly padded surf bag.

If the overall baggage weight or quantity exceeds the normal free allowance, excess baggage charges will apply.

Passengers should contact their local Emirates office for information about excess baggage rates and rules for other sporting equipment, particularly sporting weaponry.

Flights operated by other airlines: Different baggage rules may apply if the itinerary includes flights operated by other airlines. Passengers should contact Emirates or the airline concerned to confirm the applicable allowance.

5. Pets

Pets are not permitted in the cabin, except for falcons travelling between Dubai and certain destinations in Pakistan.

Depending on the circumstances, pets must be transported either as cargo or as checked baggage in the aircraft's hold.

Charges depend on the combined weight and size of the animal and its cage. These charges apply even if the passenger has no other checked baggage.

5.1 Animal Excess Baggage Charges

Animal and cage conditions	Price
Combined weight does not exceed 23 kg and dimensions do not exceed 59 inches (150 cm)	USD 500 / CAD 700
Combined weight is between 24 and 32 kg, and dimensions are between 59 inches (150 cm) and 118 inches (300 cm)	USD 650 / CAD 900
Combined weight exceeds 32 kg, and dimensions are between 59 inches (150 cm) and 118 inches (300 cm)	USD 800 / CAD 1,150
Cage dimensions exceed 118 inches (300 cm)	Must be transported as manifested cargo

5.2 Pet Travel Requirements

Passengers should contact Emirates well before departure to confirm the required procedures, which may include:

- Permits
- Tests
- Vaccinations

All required procedures must be completed before Emirates can make final arrangements for the pet. The process may take a long time, especially in complex cases.

Once the requirements are complete, passengers should allow one week to submit their paperwork to Emirates before departure.

Local airport requirements may also apply.

For further information, see the Travelling with Animals FAQ.

6. Musical Instruments

Emirates does not provide a special free baggage allowance for musical instruments.

Musical instruments may be:

- Checked baggage: Normal excess baggage charges apply if the instrument exceeds the passenger's baggage allowance.
- Cabin baggage: Subject to applicable cabin baggage limitations.
- Separate passenger-cabin seat: An instrument may be transported on a paid-for seat in the passenger cabin.

Certain conditions and limitations may apply. Passengers should contact the Emirates Help Centre for further information.

The total dimensions (length + width + height) of a musical instrument must not exceed 300 cm (118 inches) for checked baggage. Instruments exceeding this limit must be transported as cargo or freight.

7. Ship Models

When departing from Mauritius, a special charge applies to ship models. They cannot be included as part of the standard baggage allowance.

Ship model weight	Charge
First 10 kg	EUR 150
Next 10 kg	EUR 50

The maximum permitted weight of a ship model is 20 kg.

8. Items Containing Explosives Are Not Allowed on Board

Fireworks and any other items containing explosives are prohibited as both carry-on baggage and checked baggage on Emirates flights.

Examples include:

- Christmas crackers

- Firecrackers
- Bottle rockets
- Poppers
- Sparklers

9. Personal Motorised Vehicles Are Not Allowed on Board

For safety reasons, Emirates does not accept personal motorised vehicles as checked baggage or hand luggage because they contain large lithium batteries.

Examples include:

- Smart bags that operate as motorised rideable scooters
- Hoverboards
- Mini-Segways

This restriction also applies when passengers connect to Emirates flights from another airline that has accepted these items.

10. Source Links

- Emirates — Health
- Emirates — Accessible Travel
- Emirates — Cabin Baggage Rules
- Emirates — Purchase Additional Baggage Allowance
- Emirates — Travelling with Infants
- Emirates — Local Offices
- Emirates — Firearms Form
- Emirates — Travelling with Animals FAQ

11. Document Metadata for RAG

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- Topic: Unusual baggage and special allowances
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